

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

A shopping bag full of waste!



Learning Outcome

Describe social, urban, and environmental change in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- When you go grocery shopping, are you aware of the packaging that the food comes in?
- Can there be better alternatives to food packaging? What ideas do you have?

Can Do Statements

- I can describe environmental problems.
- I can talk about things that happened.
- I can talk about things that are happening and things that have happened.





Let's Explore!

What **principle*** does recycling share?

* A "principle" is a fundamental truth that serves as the foundation for a system of belief.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Last time I went food shopping, I thought about all the garbage that comes from just a simple bag of groceries - the majority of our shopping bag is easily disposable and ends up in the trash.

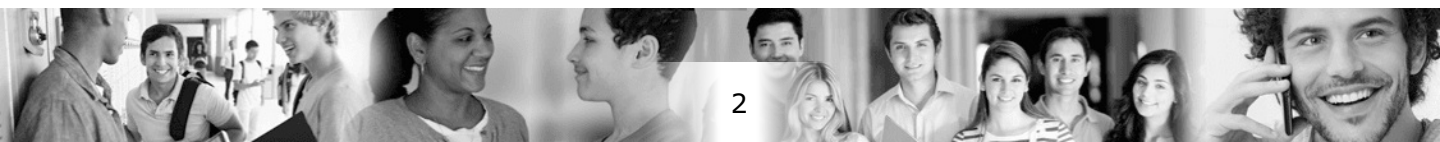
The question of what to do with all the refuse we produce has been asked repeatedly. Existing landfills are being filled up and have no capacity to hold more trash. These large dumping sites are also causing contamination of groundwater, and making the water supplies unsafe. Parts of the oceans have been polluted due to trash that is being dumped into the water by factories and individuals.

As concern for the environment grew, along with awareness of the dwindling supply of natural resources such as trees, recycling has provided us with the answer. Recycling has taken hold in major cities around the world. Recycling shares a simple principle: finding new uses for the things we no longer want.

Thanks to recycling, people have been made aware of the alternative ways to discard their trash, and have become active participants in the recycling process.

In many communities, the collection of the recyclable items is being organized by the local government. Newspapers, jars, plastic bottles, and aluminum cans are being separated and sorted into different bins. At the recycling center, the materials are sold to manufacturers to use again in the production of other items.

By giving your shopping bag a second thought, you are giving the environment a second chance.





Let's Practice!

What happened?

Instructions: Complete the text below with one of the options you are given. Practice saying the sentences aloud with a partner. Correct each other's pronunciation.

Word Bank

went, go / provide, provided / think, thought / sold, sells / grew, grow

1. Last time I _____ food shopping, I _____ about all the garbage that comes from just a simple bag of groceries.
2. As concern for the environment _____, along with awareness of the dwindling supply of natural resources such as trees, recycling _____ the answer.
3. People _____ their recycling materials to manufacturers.



Let's Practice!

Let's describe environmental problems!

Instructions: Find the words in the crossword!. Use the words to write sentences. Model a conversation with a partner using the sentences. Switch roles.

Word Bank

1. install
2. participant
3. dwindling
4. sort
5. capacity
6. disposable
7. alternative
8. dumping
9. landfill

I	S	Y	P	U	E	W	D	K	T	N	C	L	W	D
N	L	A	Y	L	E	U	W	Q	W	U	Q	X	P	I
S	M	L	C	P	U	Q	I	S	D	C	P	Y	D	S
T	D	T	L	A	I	P	N	O	Z	W	A	E	Q	P
A	K	E	Y	R	H	W	D	J	A	K	C	E	Z	O
L	S	R	R	T	O	D	L	P	S	R	I	H	X	S
L	Y	N	E	I	G	E	I	P	H	L	T	L	E	A
M	X	A	Z	C	U	H	N	K	J	R	Y	T	F	B
Q	G	T	V	I	S	A	G	V	W	G	Y	D	D	L
E	M	I	R	P	F	B	S	G	G	U	X	S	R	E
N	T	V	D	A	U	L	A	N	D	F	I	L	L	Q
V	Y	E	W	N	D	Q	G	S	N	L	I	Q	L	C
R	I	H	A	T	P	D	U	M	P	I	N	G	M	H
B	X	H	T	E	R	L	V	H	F	O	S	K	F	R
Y	G	S	O	R	T	P	H	L	B	X	B	W	A	X



Extension Activity

Take a survey.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Take a survey of people in your class or your friends.
- Ask them about their recycling practices.
- Prepare a written summary of what you found out about the people around you and their recycling practices.
- Be prepared to share your thoughts and any surprises you came across.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I take a survey about recycling.

☐ ☐

I write a summary of the survey results.

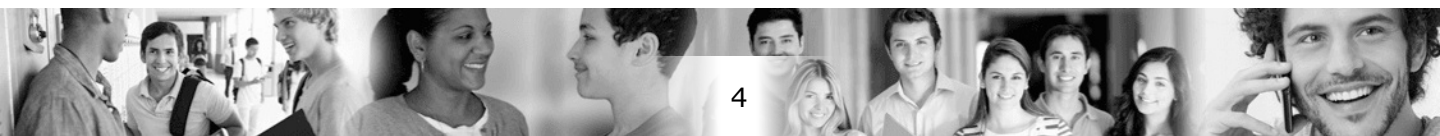
☐ ☐

I share my opinion about the survey and about recycling.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- landfill** (noun): a place where waste is buried under the ground
e.g. Existing landfills are being filled up.
- capacity** (noun): the amount of space a container or room has to hold things
e.g. Landfills have no capacity to hold more trash.
- dumping** (noun): the act of getting rid of dangerous waste material in a place that is not safe
e.g. These large dumping sites are also causing contamination.
- dwindling** (adjective): to gradually become less and less or smaller and smaller
e.g. The dwindling supply of natural resources such as trees, has increased a desire for recycling.
- alternative** (adjective): something you can choose to do or use instead of something else
e.g. Due to recycling, people have been made aware of alternative ways to help the environment.
- to discard** (verb): throw away
e.g. People have been made aware of alternative ways to discard their trash.
- aluminum** (noun): a silver-white metal that is very light and is used to make cans, cooking pans, and window frames
e.g. Newspapers, jars, plastic bottles, and aluminum cans are being separated.
- to sort** (verb): to put things in a particular order or arrange them in groups according to size or type
e.g. Recyclable items are sorted into different bins.
- participant** (noun): someone who is taking part in an activity or event
e.g. They have become active participants in the recycling process.





Learning Points

The Simple Past Tense

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about many kinds of past events: short, quickly finished actions, longer situations and repeated events.

Usually, when you use the Simple Past tense, the time of the finished action is clear from the context or explicitly mentioned in the sentence.

For example:

*Last week I **went** grocery shopping at my local grocery store.*

Here, it is clear when the action of "going" happened (last week) and that it finished in that time period.

Here is another example:

*Two weeks ago, I **threw out** a lot of garbage and I realized that I was producing too much waste.*

Remember that there are both regular and irregular verbs. Look at the chart for examples of the Simple Past tense verbs.

Regular Verb		Irregular Verb	
Present	Past	Present	Past
discover	discovered	think	thought
recognize	recognized	grow	grew

Examples:

- *Last time I went food shopping, I thought about all the garbage that comes from just a simple bag of groceries.*
- *As concern for the environment grew, along with awareness of the dwindling supply of natural resources such as trees, recycling has provided us with the answer.*





Learning Points

The Passive: The Present Continuous and Present Perfect Tenses

You use the Present Continuous to talk about an action that is happening at the time of speaking. The action or event is in progress.

*These large dumping sites **are** also **causing** contamination of groundwater, and making the water supplies unsafe.*

You use the Present Perfect to talk about a finished action or event with present consequences. There is a connection between what happened in the past and the present.

*People **have become** active participants in the recycling process.*

You often choose the passive form when you want to talk about an action but are not so interested in saying who or what does/did it. Passives without *agents* (the doers) are common in academic and scientific writing.

Look at the chart below for the structure of the passive voice.

Name	Structure	Example
Present Continuous	<i>am/are/is + being + past participle</i>	<i>Parts of oceans have been polluted due to trash that is being dumped into the water by factories and individuals.</i>
Present Perfect	<i>have/has + been + past participle</i>	<i>The question of what to do with all the refuse we produce has been asked repeatedly.</i>

Examples:

- *Existing landfills are being filled up and have no capacity to hold more trash.*
- *These large dumping sites are also causing contamination of groundwater, and making the water supplies unsafe.*
- *Thanks to recycling, people have been made aware of alternative ways to discard their trash, and have become active participants in the recycling process.*
- *In many communities, the collection of recyclable items is being organized by the local government.*
- *Newspapers, jars, plastic bottles, and aluminum cans are being separated and sorted into different bins.*

